

The Morning: History makers

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The New York Times
The Morning

March 8, 2026



Good morning. The Israeli military struck several Iranian fuel sites late last night, and videos from Tehran showed [columns of flames and smoke](#) climbing into the sky. We have more on the war below. And you can follow updates [here](#).

But first, on this International Women’s Day, we’re writing about a project to unearth stories of remarkable women from The Times’s archives.



The New York Times

History makers



By Amisha Padnani

I'm an editor on The Times's Obituaries desk.

What happens when you read about the lives of notable women across time?
You start to see what history noticed — and what it didn't.

For Women's History Month, my colleagues and I pored over hundreds of obituaries in The New York Times archives. Our new project, which we published this weekend, revisits the stories of more than 100 women and reveals how they were seen in their own time. [You can read it here.](#)

Some stories were familiar. Many were not. Often, even when I was reading about a notable figure, I would learn some new detail that made me ask: How had I not known this about her?

Take **Hedy Lamarr**. I had heard her name, sure — it blazed across marquees and movie posters in the 1930s and '40s. Her obituary, from 2000, had no shortage of adjectives about her striking appearance. What I hadn't realized was that she was a prolific inventor whose ideas helped lay the groundwork for modern wireless communication, GPS and Bluetooth. Only two paragraphs mentioned her scientific contributions, almost as a reluctant aside.

That pattern appeared throughout the archives. Achievements minimized. Talents framed as curiosities. Women memorialized first for how they looked, or whom they married, before their own accomplishments.

And yet, the vibrant lives of these women shone through.



The journalist **Martha Gellhorn**, who covered wars around the world, once wrote about traveling with her husband, Ernest Hemingway — whom she referred to only as Unwilling Companion. After divorcing him and two other husbands, she concluded that marriage was boring.

Moments like that stayed with me.

Oriana Fallaci was a glamorous and incisive journalist known for her aggressive style of interviewing prominent people. **Sylvia Rivera** was a lively transgender activist who, amid the Stonewall riots, shouted to her lover, “I’m not missing a minute of this — it’s the revolution!”

A portrait shows **Indira Gandhi** — India’s first and only female prime minister — seated gracefully in a deep red sari, with her hands folded, beside a small arrangement of yellow flowers. The image is elegant and composed, the kind of photograph meant to project calm authority.

These women didn’t wait for the world to expand possibilities for them. They expanded those possibilities themselves.

Reading these stories also made me think about the women who shape us in quieter ways.

When I was young, I didn’t spend much time imagining what kind of woman I would become. The person who shaped me most wasn’t a celebrity or a historical figure. It was my aunt, who moved to the United States from India when I was 6, shortly after my parents divorced. She was funny and generous and cared deeply about doing the right thing. It’s a lesson that has stayed with me: You live according to your values. Recognition, if it comes, is beside the point.

That idea kept coming back to me as I read the obituaries. Most of the women in these pages did not set out to become famous. They followed their convictions and pushed into spaces that had not been built for them. Often they paid a price for it.

Reading about their lives has been an energizing exercise, and yet a frustrating one. Again and again, the larger fight — to be seen clearly, to be taken seriously

— felt familiar.

Their stories don't feel like artifacts from the past. They feel like part of a conversation that is still unfolding.



THE LATEST NEWS

The Iran War



Tehran this morning. Arash Khamooshi for The New York Times

The first week of attacks by the U.S. and Israel pummeled Iran and killed top leaders. But it also showed that President Trump has [no clear idea for how the war should end](#).

A U.S. intelligence report predating the war concluded that even a large-scale military assault would be [unlikely to topple](#) Iran's theocratic

government.

Masoud Pezeshkian, the Iranian president, [apologized for the missile strikes](#) that have hit Gulf states — even as the strikes continued.

The remains of the first U.S. service members killed in the conflict [arrived at Dover Air Force Base yesterday](#).

Iran or another group [could retrieve](#) Iran's primary store of highly enriched uranium even though U.S. strikes buried it last year, according to classified intelligence reports.

Gas prices in the U.S. have [risen 14 percent in a week](#) because the war has cut off a large portion of the world's crude oil supply.

Politics

Trump [announced a coalition](#) to “eradicate” drug cartels at a summit of Latin American and Caribbean leaders yesterday in Florida.

ICE agents in Nashville [detained a local journalist](#) who covers immigration.

Police officers in Manhattan arrested six people after a clash between anti-Islamic protesters and counterprotesters [turned violent](#) outside the home of Mayor Zohran Mamdani.

A federal judge ruled that Kari Lake's appointment as head of the U.S. Agency for Global Media [was invalid](#), voiding the mass layoffs she had carried out at Voice of America.

Around the World



Balendra Shah, right, during his campaign. Hannah Reyes Morales for The New York Times

Nepal: Balendra Shah, a former rapper, is on track to become the next prime minister. Partial results from Thursday's election [show his party winning a landslide victory.](#)

Colombia: Voters head to the polls today to cast their ballots in congressional elections. Candidates [have experienced kidnappings and death threats](#).

Canada: Gunfire struck [two synagogues in the Toronto area](#) late Friday and early Saturday. Another local synagogue was damaged by gunfire on Monday.

Other Big Stories

Dozens of former employees of Noma, one of the world's top restaurants, say its founding chef, René Redzepi, inflicted [physical and psychological violence](#) on the staff for years.

Daylight saving time has begun. Why do we still [change our clocks twice a year](#)?

Runners competing in today's Los Angeles Marathon can get a finisher's medal [after completing only 18 miles](#) because high temperatures are expected.

Fallout from the Epstein files continues. In the video below, David Fahrenthold, an investigative reporter, describes how Jeffrey Epstein used a small circle of doctors to control the medical care of the young women from overseas who were having sex with him. **Click to play.**





The New York Times

THE SUNDAY DEBATE

Can the war on Iran prevent the proliferation of nuclear weapons?

Yes. Previous attempts to rein in Iran's nuclear program have only delayed the threat. Trump's war on Iran was the "right decision for this, and future generations of Americans," [Van Hipp writes for Fox News](#). "And China and Russia are taking note that this president is different."

No. The war is a stark break from the diplomacy and stringent restrictions that went into the now-defunct nuclear deal with Iran. "What conclusion may countries draw from this episode?" [Damian Murphy and Andrew Miller ask in DC Journal](#). "Perhaps, developing nuclear weapons is essential for maintaining power."

FROM OPINION

When **Rebecca Norris Webb** needs solace, she heads to the Great Plains. After losing her father, she returned there — and [encountered an owl bearing an unmistakable resemblance](#).

At least one Palestinian citizen of Israel is killed each day, on average, largely by Arab organized crime and gun violence. To ease this crime wave, [Israel should work to reduce its segregation and inequality](#), **Mairav Zonszein** writes.

Here is a column by **Maureen Dowd** on [MAGA's version of "Wuthering Heights."](#)

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MORNING READS



In Munich in 2024. Laetitia Vancon for The New York Times

Hang zehn: Despite sitting 200 miles from the sea, Munich had a hopping surf community. But its most beloved spot, [a human-made wave in a creek](#), has been ruined.

Cute overload: Social media is flooded with A.I. videos of animals doing things beyond the bounds of belief. Those clips risk [making us numb to nature's real wonders](#).

A wartime Ramadan: Missiles are falling across the Middle East as millions of people there fast and meditate on restraint. In *Believing*, Lauren Jackson [explores the incongruity](#). ([Sign up to get *Believing* here](#).)

A sculptor: Thaddeus Mosley spent nearly 70 years creating bold wooden sculptures before finally gaining international attention in his early 90s. [He died at 99](#).



SPORTS

N.C.A.A.: Top-ranked Duke [defeated its rival North Carolina](#) 76-61 last night, avenging its loss earlier this season.

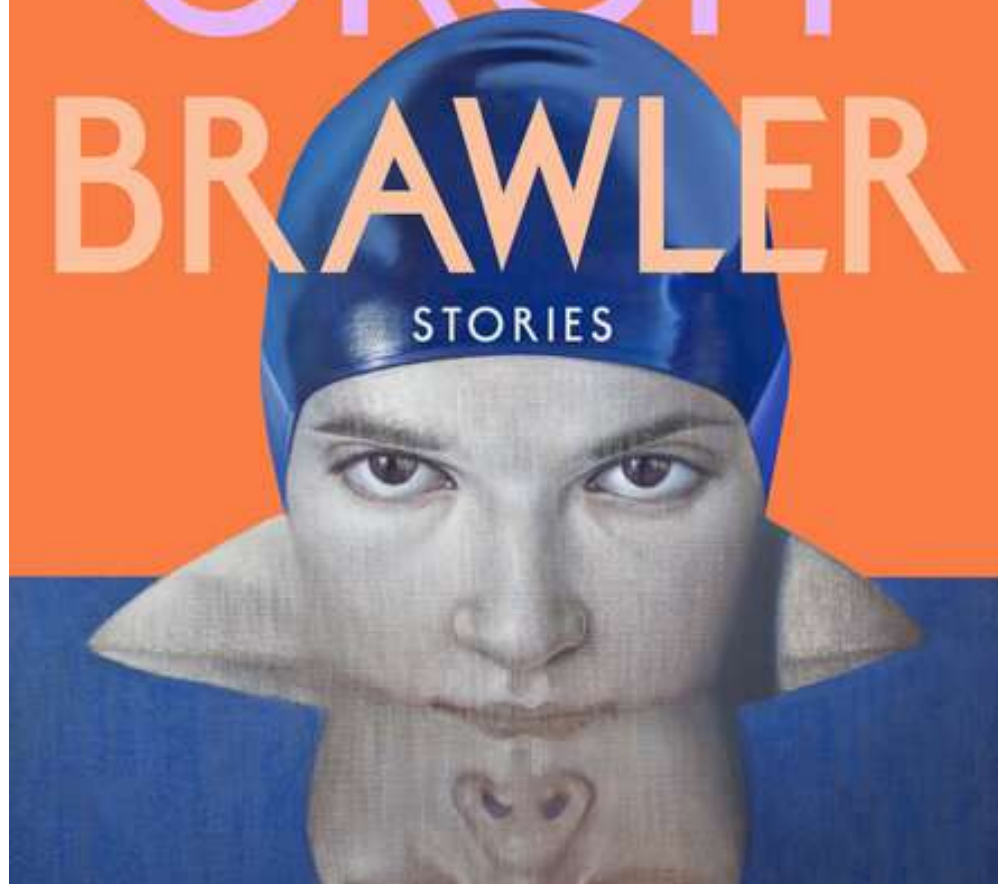
U.F.C.: The fight card for [an event at the White House](#) on June 14 will feature Ilia Topuria and Justin Gaethje competing for the UFC lightweight title.



BOOK OF THE WEEK

NEW YORK TIMES BESTSELLING AUTHOR

LAUREN
GROFF
BRAWLER
STORIES





By Elisabeth Egan

“Brawler,” by Lauren Groff: If the nine stories in this best-selling collection have a theme, our critic writes, it’s “how the bedrock of family crumbles, and its members are forced to shift into new formations, occasionally tectonic.” Groff is best known for novels like “The Vaster Wilds” (2023) and “Fates and Furies” (2015), but in this trove of prickly, moving tales, she proves that it’s possible to contain entire worlds in a literary space the length of a sitcom (minus the com, in most cases). Brace for the gut punch at the end of the first one. [Read our review.](#)

THE INTERVIEW



Devin Oktar Yalkin for The New York Times



By David Marchese

This week's subject for The Interview is the best-selling writer and activist Rebecca Solnit, whose new book, "The Beginning Comes After the End," asks if there's a different and more hopeful story to tell about our seemingly chaotic world.

When people are reading the news and feel as if they're barreling into a grim dystopian future, what would show them that there are deeper currents of *positive* change happening?

Even the right tells us something encouraging. They tell us: You are very powerful. You've changed the world profoundly. There is a backlash, and it is significant. But it is not comprehensive. I was on a book tour last year in Europe, and the Europeans astounded me by being like: Oh, *Roe v. Wade* was overturned — doesn't that mean feminism has failed? The United States is 4 percent of the population. Meanwhile, all these Catholic countries — Argentina, Mexico, Ireland, Spain — have greatly expanded reproductive rights. So it's really how you tell the story.

One of the defining counternarratives of the last few years could fall under the umbrella of "the resistance." I would like to hear your perspective on whether any of the strategies against President Trump have been counterproductive. That is, if calling him or the movement fascist, sexist, racist pushed people into their respective corners?

I get so tired of the idea that progressives have gone too far in asserting that every human being deserves human rights when people are being shot in the

streets of Minneapolis. We are facing such horrific brutality. Politeness is not really the problem. You do not get authoritarians to behave better by being meek and gentle and polite. You get it by being strong.

It seems as if the public is hungry for an individual to be a counterweight to Trump. But for whatever reason, that person has yet to be identified. Why?

The world mostly gets changed through collective effort. We don't have to look for an individual, for a savior, for an Übermensch. I think the counter to Trump always has been and always will be civil society.

Read more of the interview [here](#). Or [watch a longer version on YouTube](#).



THE NEW YORK TIMES MAGAZINE



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THE MORNING RECOMMENDS ...

Style your hair like a pro using these accessories, from [ceramic curling irons](#) to [texturizing shears](#).

Get a thrill from one of these [nerve-shredding new novels](#), recommended by our columnist.

Eat something other than a “slop bowl.” Customers are [growing tired of them and their sky-high prices](#).

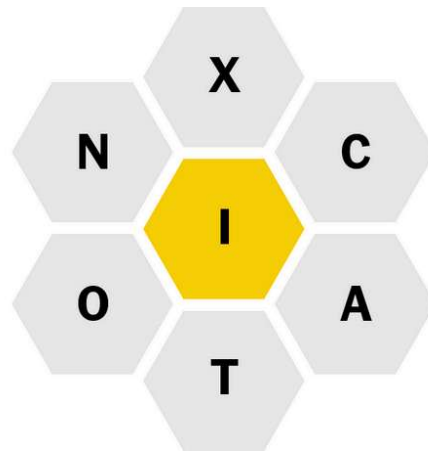
MEAL PLAN



Linda Xiao for The New York Times

Maybe you've had your share of soup for the season and want something totally different. Emily Weinstein, the editor of New York Times Cooking, has some [dishes off the beaten path](#), to bring some excitement to your table. Like: [crispy halloumi with tomatoes and white beans](#), and Turkish eggs with yogurt. You'll be glad you tried them.

NOW TIME TO PLAY



Here is [today's Spelling Bee](#). Yesterday's pangrams were *borrowing* and *browning*.

Can you put eight historical events — including the breaking of the sound barrier, Attila the Hun's defeat and the arrival of humans in Australia — in chronological order? [Take this week's Flashback quiz](#).

And here are [today's Mini Crossword](#), [Wordle](#), [Crossplay](#), [Connections](#) and [Strands](#).

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